Your magazine from Gallions

Gallions Housing Association

thamesview

news • events • competitions



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It's here! Welfare benefits changes have arrived - P5 - 7

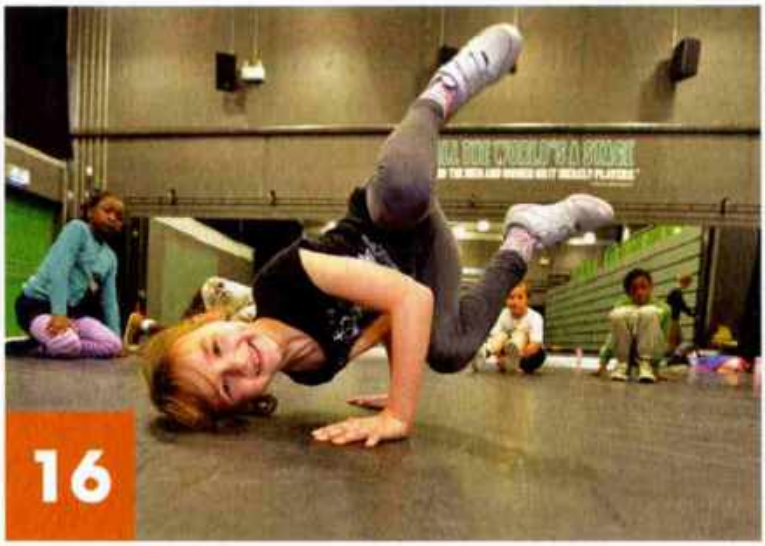
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Contact us:
0300 123 1237

For those residents who are hearing impaired we offer the Typetalk service.

Write to us:
PO BOX 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB

Visit us:
15 Joyce Dawson Way, London, SE28 8RA

Customer Contact Team:
0300 123 1237

Repairs Contact Team:
0300 123 1238

Text Relay: 18001

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RESIDENTS

This section explains what advice Gallions, our partners and local community groups would like to tell residents. This could include ways you can get involved with your local community or advice on money, housing or DIY activities.

NEIGHBOURS

This section explains what's going on in your neighbourhood - everything from events to what exciting projects your neighbours are up to and ways to get involved.

If you would like to submit an article to this section please email communications@gallionsha.co.uk or call 0208 308 4080

TENANTS VIEW

This section is for residents by residents. Get involved and write an article from your point of view on what's happening in your community. Get your neighbours talking about local issues or things to celebrate!

If you would like to submit an article to this section please email communications@gallionsha.co.uk or call 0208 308 4080

GALLIONS

This section is where you be able to find the latest information on what Gallion is up to; everything from performance to what local offers we have available. You will find out all the latest information from your landlord here.

EVENTS

This section is where you can sit back with a cup of tea or coffee and plan your events & have a go at our crosswords and win some prizes.

WELCOME

AS YOU MAKE YOUR WAY AROUND THAMESMEAD IT IS EASY TO SEE SPRING IS IN THE AIR. THERE ARE FLOWERS BLOOMING AND THE TREES HAVE GOT THEIR LEAVES BACK.

Residents and staff at Gallions have been anticipating spring for more than the colour and warmth, but because government changes around benefits have started. We encourage you to read our feature story on welfare reform and make sure you know how or if the changes affect you.

Earlier last month Gallions and Charlton coordinated a 'Junior Master Cook' competition at a local Thamesmead school, Windrush Primary. Students channelled their inner chef and came up with three yummy meals to feed to the judges – check out the photos on page 29 and find out how you can get a free cookbook!

Gallions' intention to become part of the Peabody Group - find out more about it on page 18 & 19.



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Gallions Residents' Group

Gallions Housing Association

WELFARE BENEFITS CHANGES: MYTH BUSTER

WE HAVE MET WITH HUNDREDS OF OUR RESIDENTS OVER THE PAST FEW MONTHS; ANSWERING THEIR QUESTIONS AND CLEARING UP ANY MISUNDERSTANDINGS AROUND THE BENEFITS CHANGES.

After months of planning, changes to the welfare benefits system have finally arrived. Two of the biggest changes that came in this month were the revised rules around under occupancy (some like to call it the bedroom tax) and the council tax reduction scheme. The council tax reduction scheme roughly means that if you are of working age and claim council tax benefit, the amount of support you receive may be cut due to a reduction in government funding and the fact that councils are responsible for running their own schemes.

We have been promoting the changes for several months now, particularly the under-occupancy rules, and the chances are high that you would have either come across an article in Thamesview or a letter in the post addressing the changes. We were also out and about in the community; running five road shows throughout Thamesmead back in February, where we saw over 100 residents. All that promotion and interaction with residents gave us a really good idea of the concerns most of you had and also some of the common myths held.
To address some of your concerns and help clear up any misunderstandings, we produced a handy 'myth buster' document; which is featured below.

Here are some of the most common myths.

I get Disability Living Allowance (DLA) so I am not liable for the bedroom tax.

Receipt of this benefit does not exempt you from the bedroom tax. However, if you have a carer (who does not normally live with you) but provides overnight care, you will be allowed a further bedroom for them.

I am a pensioner and can't afford the bedroom tax.

If you or your partner are of pension credit age, you will not be affected by the bedroom tax.

My partner and I cannot share a bedroom due to a medical condition so the bedroom tax will not apply.

You will have to pay the bedroom tax initially, but we would recommend you apply immediately for a Discretionary Housing Payment from the council and contact our Money and Benefits Advice Team for assistance in raising an appeal.

WELFARE BENEFITS CHANGES: MYTH BUSTER



I have two children and need bedrooms for each, so the bedroom tax will not apply.

- Two children under the age of 10 are expected to share regardless of their sex.
- Two children of the same sex under the age of 16 are expected to share.
- That said, if a child has a medical condition that makes it impractical for the children to share, we recommend you contact our Money and Benefits Advice Team immediately for further advice.

My children/grandchildren come to stay at weekends, I need the extra room(s), so the bedroom tax will not apply.

If the address is not their normal place of residence, you will be deemed to have a spare room(s) and incur bedroom tax.

My child attends University and only returns home during holiday times so I will incur bedroom tax.

We recommend you contact our Money and Benefits Advice Team immediately for further advice.

My son/daughter is serving in the Armed Forces, so I will incur the bedroom tax whilst they are away.

No. An extra room is allowed for members of the Armed Forces who are serving away from home but intending to return.

I am a foster carer so I need to keep a spare room for when I foster a child but cannot afford the bedroom tax between placements.

People who are approved foster carers will be allowed an additional room, whether or not a child has been placed with them or they are between placements, so long as they have fostered a child, or become an approved foster carer in the last 12 months.

I am a joint tenant and of working age but my co-tenant is of pension credit age, I shouldn't be affected by the bedroom tax?
If you are 'partners' and one of you is of pension credit age, the bedroom tax will not apply. However, if you are not partners, but for example, mother and daughter, the situation is slightly different in that the tenant of pension credit age will not be affected but the tenant of working age would see a proportional reduction in their housing benefit entitlement.

When Universal Credit comes in, I will ask for the housing costs element to be sent direct to Gallions.
This will not be possible in the majority of cases, as the Government have ruled that Universal Credit will be paid direct to claimants, for all but the most vulnerable. It will be the claimant's responsibility to manage their money effectively and pay their rent and other bills in a timely manner.

When Disability Living Allowance (DLA) is phased out, I will automatically get the new Personal Independence Payment (PIP) benefit.
No, however, before your DLA is due to end, the Department for Work and Pensions (DWP) will write to you inviting you to apply for PIP. If you respond promptly, you will remain on DLA until a decision is made on the new claim.

Children in receipt of DLA will not be affected until they reach their 16th birthday, at which point they will be invited to claim PIP. Those aged 65 and over that receive DLA will be unaffected by the change and will remain on DLA.



Help and advice
It's important to remember to keep your rent account up to date as failure to do so could put your home at risk.
If you need more information about the changes or general money management advice, contact our Money and Benefits Advice Team:

t: 0300 123 1237
e: enquiries@gallionsha.co.uk
www.gallionsha.co.uk

HOW YOUR VIEWS SHAPE SERVICES THROUGH LOCAL OFFERS

LOCAL OFFERS ARE GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION'S WAY OF TAILORING OUR SERVICES BASED ON YOUR PRIORITIES AND SUGGESTED IMPROVEMENTS FOR YOUR NEIGHBOURHOOD.

Sam, who is the resident engagement and consultation co-ordinator sat down with us to discuss the new local offers plan that will be rolled out to residents throughout this year until 2015.

How are you going to ensure that our residents' areas stay clean and safe?

'One of the local offers will be that caretakers will be added to estate inspections in addition to neighbourhood officers and wardens. This will help reduce the time it takes to address concerns residents have in their areas about cleanliness.

Because the caretakers are the ones doing the job – they will be able to speak to the residents on the spot about their concerns.'

'Residents often have very good relationships with their caretakers as they are around the estates more than any other employee. We think this will also improve the turn out of residents to the inspections.'

'In terms of safe neighbourhoods we will actively signpost residents to their



local police safer neighbourhoods. In addition, we will be publicising what improvements and programmes the safer neighbourhoods team is offering.'

What local offers will there be to encourage young people to get involved?

'The resident engagement team is going to be researching existing activities in the relevant boroughs to find out what activities and groups exist and then let our young people know about these opportunities.'

How will the local offers help bring the community together?

'We will provide activities to give residents an opportunity to meet each other who live in the same neighbourhood. We will also be signposting residents to existing community groups and ways to get involved.'

How will you measure the success of the local offers?

There will be several ways we will be measuring the success, including:

- monitoring internally
- Gallions' Resident Group will scrutinise the action plan to determine areas of success and improvement
- reviewing our challenges regularly.

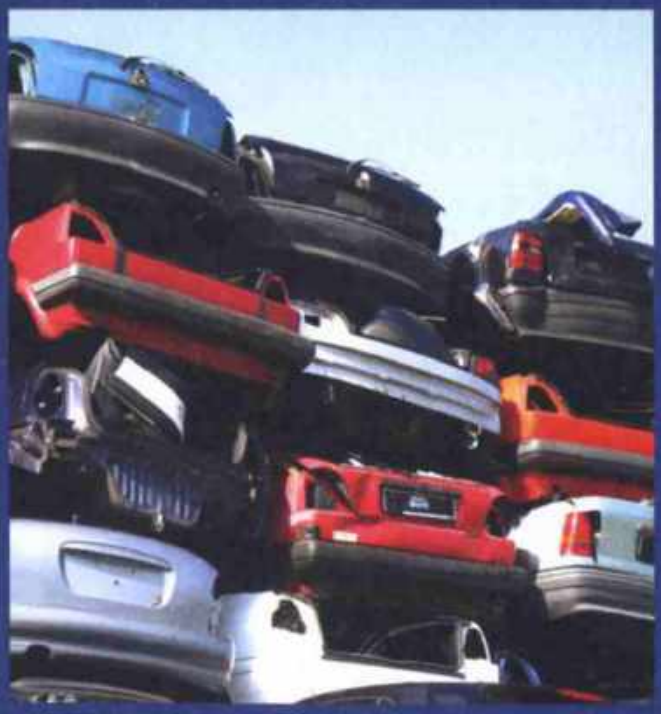
To view our local offers visit our website www.gallionsha.co.uk

UNWANTED CARS TAKEN AWAY FREE OF CHARGE!

As part of the 'We Love Green' campaign Team Gallions (TG) is offering to take away your unused or unwanted car for free. This service is offered to any service charge payer – including free holders at no cost.

If you take advantage of the scheme you will be assured that TG will legally dispose of your vehicle in line with current recycling legislation.

If you're interested please come into our Joyce Dawson Way office and surrender the logbook, keys and sign a simple declaration (note: you must be the registered owner) 15 Joyce Dawson Way, London, SE28 8RA



NATURAL ESTATES: TOP TIPS

The Natural Estates project is a partnership between London Wildlife Trust and Gallions. It helps Thamesmead residents to get more out of the estate's green spaces by running events and activities that enhance the common areas for people and wildlife.

What can you do for wildlife in your area this spring?

- Create a mini-wildflower meadow in your garden or window box.
- Plant out annuals and perennials like wood anemone, foxglove, ox-eye chamomile, bugle, ivy-leaved toadflax and blessed Mary's thistle to attract insects and butterflies, and brighten up your spring.



VOLUNTEERING OPPORTUNITIES

At the moment the Trust is looking for environmental education volunteers to help run school sessions at Tump 53 Nature Reserve. Located in the heart of Thamesmead this hidden gem is an incredible resource for local residents and children and the hope is that with the help of volunteers it can be opened to the public and schools more often.

This opportunity would be suitable for residents who have an interest in nature, love working with children and have a couple of hours to spare on Thursdays. For more information please contact Natural Estates project officer: Jeannine Moros-Noujaim at **jmoros-noujaim@wildlondon.org.uk or 07702 671068**

HELP WITH TRAINING AND JOB SEARCHES

BUILDING FUTURES IS A FREE SERVICE FROM TRUST THAMESMEAD OFFERING SUPPORT, ADVICE AND GUIDANCE TO LOCAL PEOPLE LOOKING FOR TRAINING AND EMPLOYMENT.

They can help you:

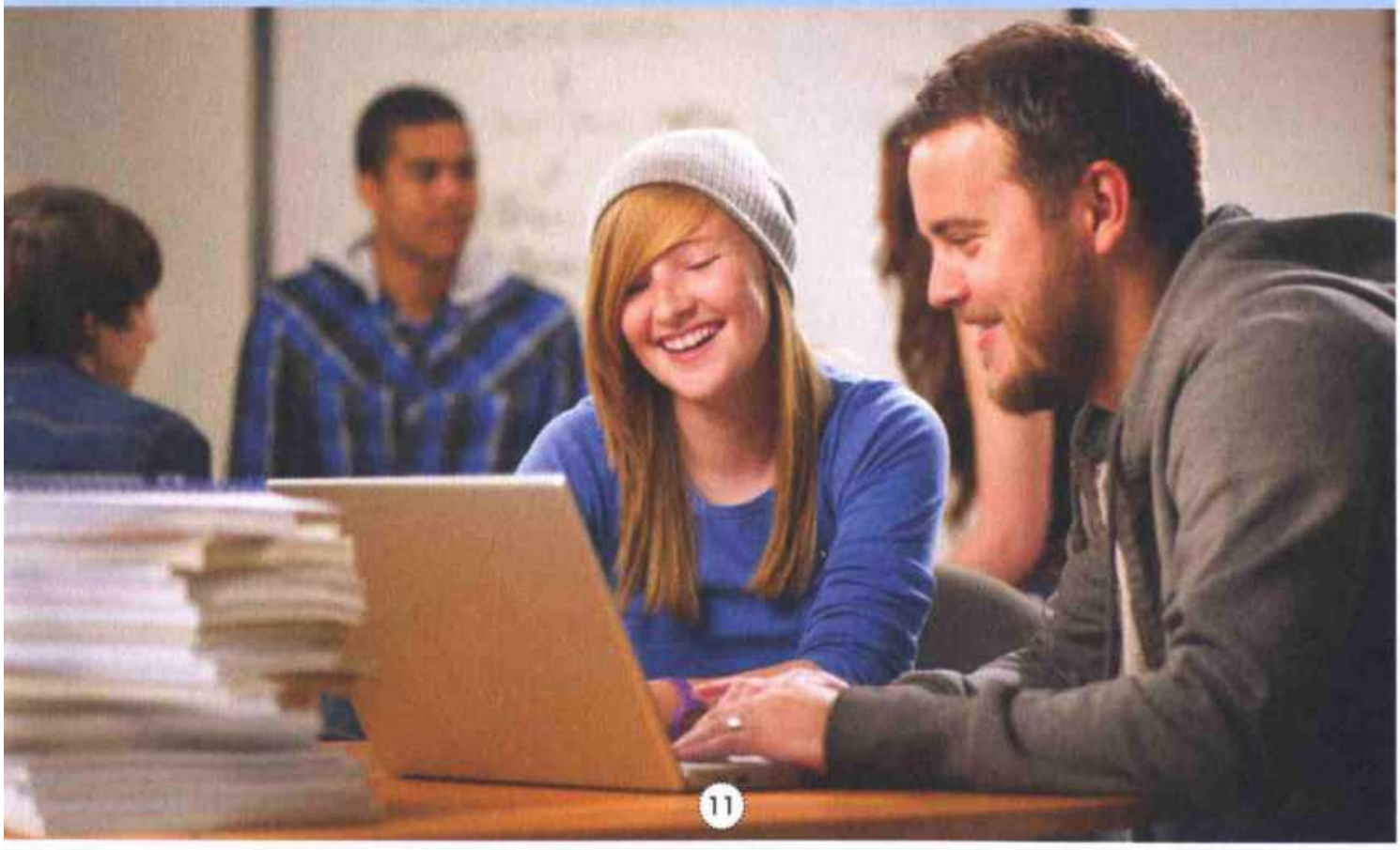
- assess individual training & employment needs
- develop a personal action plan
- find the right job through their job search service
- with practical help including CV writing, form filling and interview preparation
- by providing IT access if needed

But don't take our word for it! From April 2012 – Jan 2013, Building Futures assisted 487 Thamesmead residents with training and helped 160 to find a job.

Training is tailored for individuals needs and range from Information and Communication Technology (ICT), English for Speakers of Other Languages (ESOL), Care, Warehousing, Security, Employability Skills and many more. Don't delay, make an appointment today!

Contact Trust Thamesmead, 19a Joyce Dawson Way, Thamesmead Town Centre, SE28 8RA.

t:020 8320 4470
e:contact@trust-thamesmead.co.uk



AXIS AND GALLIONS CELEBRATE 10 YEARS OF PARTNERSHIP BY SENDING RESIDENTS TO CHARLTON GAME



Gallions Housing Association and Axis celebrate ten years of partnership working with a celebratory event that saw 460 local residents attending a Charlton football game over the Easter weekend.

Local residents enjoyed the game and one resident we spoke to, Jacqueline Osborne had never before been to a football match: "this is my first football game and I wasn't sure what I would think of it but now I am here I am quite excited, I keep thinking wow its a real football game!"

In addition to sending local residents to the game, Gallions and Axis have produced a joint document to highlight how true partnership working can bring benefits, including service improvement and efficiency savings.

Over the life of the partnership over two million pounds of savings have been made. This year alone the partnership has identified one hundred thousand pounds worth of efficiency savings, which will be reinvested in further service improvement projects.
Together the partnership has delivered an extensive corporate social responsibility programme that has supported twenty Gallions' residents to kick start their careers through an apprenticeship programme.
The successful corporate social responsibility programme includes forty two local students being introduced into the work place in order to help to inspire young people into the workforce.

Tony Cotter, Chief Executive, had this to say about the partnership: "Over the last decade the partnership has gone from strength to strength, delivering a cutting edge service and generating substantial innovative savings for our residents. One of the key reasons the partnership works so well is that we have a relationship that is built on trust and mutual respect fostering open and honest dialogue from the start".

John Hayes, Axis Chief Executive, "We look forward to continuing our partnership with the same drive for innovative solutions, the same motivation for improving standards and the same focus on increasing resident satisfaction, as we started with on day one".



LOCAL DANCE GROUP IN THAMESMEAD!

Dynamix is a dance school in Thamesmead that offers streetdance lessons. It's offered to kids 6-15 years old and costs only £3.00 per session! It's affordable, fun and a great way for your kids to make other friends and have fun while they're at it!

It's located at Byron Close, Thamesmead, SE28 8AA
Contact: Joanne 07828 897644
e: dynamixyoungdx@gmail.com

THE COMMUNITY GROWING TOGETHER GARDEN

It's been a busy few months for the Friends of Thamesmead Parks Group. Supported by Gallions, they have successfully created a community food growing garden at Titmuss Avenue in the Moorings area of Thamesmead in just 4 months!

After a lot of hard work almost all of the building work has been completed and we are now offering local residents the opportunity to come along, sign up and to grow fruit and vegetables for themselves and their families to enjoy.

To find out more contact:
Kelly Sullivan 020 8308 4134
e: ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk



From above, November 2012 to below, February 2013





THAMESMEAD IN BLOOM COMPETITION

FRIENDS OF THAMESMEAD PARKS ARE RUNNING THAMESMEAD IN BLOOM COMPETITION AGAIN THIS YEAR.

Supported by Gallions they will be running a garden competition to celebrate residents who take pride in their gardens and want to show them off!

The deadline for application is Friday 14 June with judging to take place over Thursday 18 July and Friday 19 July. This year there will be an additional category for schools.

To receive a nomination form contact Kelly Sullivan on 0300 123 1237 e: ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk

DO YOU HAVE UNUSED OR UNWANTED FURNITURE?

WHY NOT TAKE IT TO THE THAMESMEAD FURNITURE RECYCLE? HELP IT FIND A GOOD HOME AND PROVIDE RESIDENTS A NICE COZY BED OR COUCH.

It is open Monday-Friday 09.00-14.00 and alternate Saturdays

They are at the Undercroft, Kale Road DA18 4BJ

Email: thamesmead-furniture-recycle@live.co.uk
Phone: 0208 312 9191



THE LINK THAMESMEAD **IS WHERE IT'S AT**

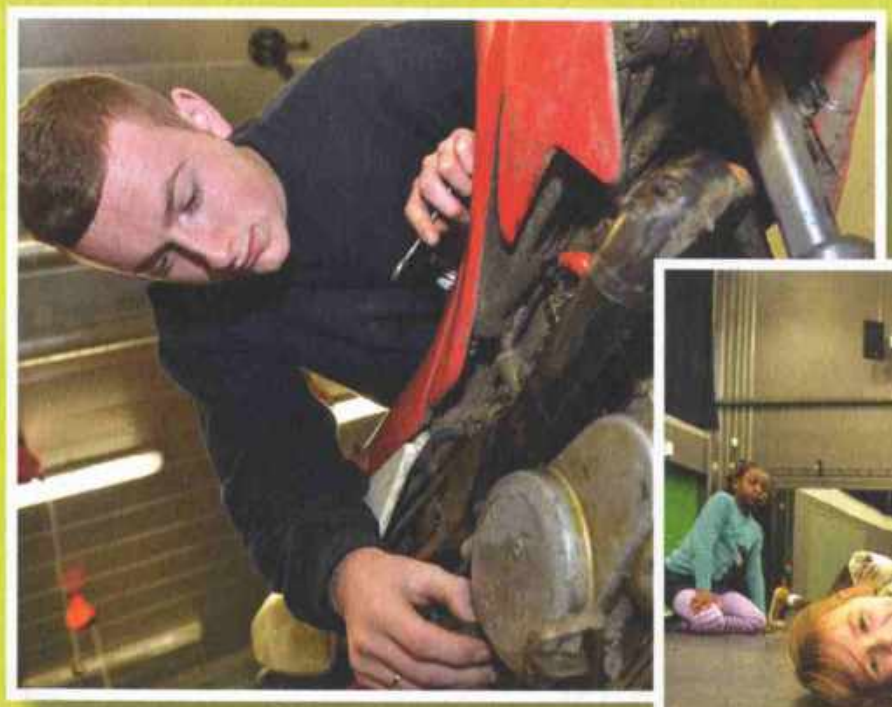
THE LINK THAMESMEAD IS THE PLACE TO BE FOR PROJECTS, EVENTS, TRAINING AND OPPORTUNITIES!

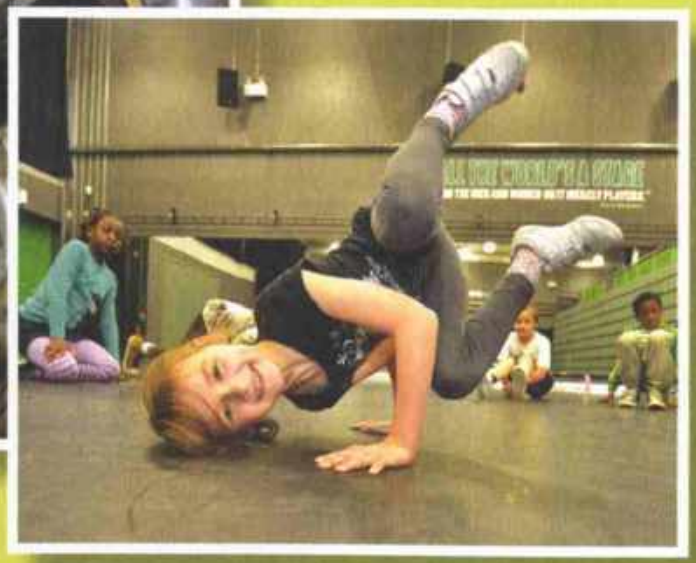
The Link Thamesmead also offers a café and a range of activities, including indoor climbing, high and low ropes courses, singing, dancing and acting classes, motor mechanic workshops, cookery and photography courses, a fitness gym, film club, weekly adult dance classes and arts and crafts workshops, fortnightly dressmaking and knitting meetings and young people's groups, as well as spaces for hire including a recording studio, rehearsal room, I.T. suite, a 160 seat theatre and meeting rooms, featuring all the latest technology.

As well as offering something for everyone, every day of the week, The Link Thamesmead works with Sporting Club Thamesmead in hosting school holiday activities.

For more information log onto: www.thelinkthamesmead.co.uk or follow them on Facebook!

Visit: The Link Thamesmead, Belvedere Road (off Harrow Manor Way), Thamesmead, SE2 9BS.
t: 020 8320 4499
e:contact@thelinkthamesmead.co.uk





TENANTS VIEW:

NEWS AND VIEWS FROM GALLIONS RESIDENTS.

ADVERTISE YOUR LOCAL BUSINESS

ARE YOU A RESIDENT OF GALLIONS? DO YOU OWN YOUR OWN BUSINESS?

However big or small email us to find out how we can help you get the word out and help us support your entrepreneurship!

e: communications@gallionsha.co.uk to find out more, or call 0300 123 1237 and ask for the communications team.



A LITTLE COURTESY WILL HELP EVERYONE ENJOY THE PUBLIC SPACES

LOCAL THAMESMEAD RESIDENT, STAN REACHES OUT TO DOG OWNERS ABOUT CLEANING UP AFTER THEIR PETS



Dog fouling has reached a terrible state in Thamesmead. The lawns are for everyone to enjoy and when owners of pets allow their animals to foul on the open public spaces it poses an inconvenience to everyone- not to mention the potential health risks to children. It is time for residents to report this to your local neighbourhood officer. Summer is fast approaching and it would be nice to enjoy the parks and green spaces without having to worry about stepping in anything unpleasant!

- Local Thamesmead resident, Stan.



RESIDENT QUESTION AND ANSWER WITH GALLIONS

Q **'Should tenants be advised in writing when scaffolding is erected? If this does not happen; what should tenants do?**
– Local Thamesmead resident, Dave

A The provision of scaffold is the responsibility of our contractor. They make an assessment under health and safety regulations and then a advise GHA. The responsibility for notification lies with our contractor – Axis. Notification should be 10 days before erection.

It is not always possible to provide ten days notice as occasionally scaffolds need to be erected urgently, for instance:

- To stop water penetration
- To remove dangerous building elements
- To carry out emergency repairs

If residents have concerns regarding a scaffold, they should contact 0800 123 1238 who should be able to resolve the issue or if you are still not satisified you can make a formal complaint with Gallions through our complaints systems via telephone, email, through our website or in writing.

Gallions & Peabody

GALLIONS INTENDS TO BECOME A SUBSIDIARY OF PEABODY

Peabody and Gallions, have reached an agreement to accelerate the regeneration of Thamesmead in south east London. The agreement sets out the intention for Gallions to become a subsidiary of the Peabody Group in the autumn.

Following in-depth discussions exploring the options for joint working, the agreement was formally approved on 25th April 2013.

This agreement will enable regeneration plans for South Thamesmead to be brought forward, including the following investment over the next 10 years:

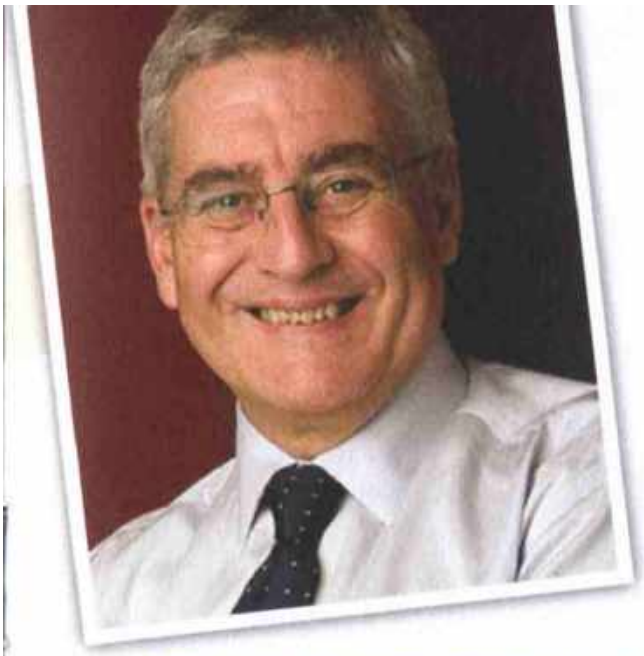
- £50 million to refurbish 19 high rise blocks
- £10 million in neighbourhood improvements such as improving bridge links and walkways
- £165 million to provide 700 new homes

The agreement is subject to approval by the Homes and Communities Agency. Further details will be regularly published in future editions of Thamesview and on Gallions' website: www.gallionsha.co.uk.

If you have any questions you can contact us:

- By post- Your Your Views, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB
- By email to yourviews@gallionsha.co.uk
- By calling 0300 1231237
- Suggestions and comments box at Joyce Dawson Way
- Consultation bus: 4th June 2013 - 3pm to 6.30pm Coralline Walk (corner of Harrow Manor Way and Lensbury Way)





MESSAGE FROM STEVE HOWLETT

PEABODY CHIEF EXECUTIVE

I'm very excited that Peabody will be working with Gallions to speed up the regeneration of Thamesmead. Our shared aims are to deliver new homes, ensure that existing homes are well maintained and improved, and to work closely with Trust Thamesmead to expand community programmes.

Peabody's mission is to make London a city of opportunity for everyone by ensuring that as many people as possible have a good home (a place that is safe, warm, clean, light and well maintained); a real sense of purpose (through work, learning, caring for others, personal development or volunteering); and a strong sense of belonging (active involvement in the neighbourhood and the spirit of togetherness and friendliness that goes with it). This is the driving force behind everything we do.

Over the last 150 years Peabody has played an important role in turning around some of the most disadvantaged areas in the capital. Our portfolio includes Victorian, Edwardian, post war and 21st century homes and many of our estates are in central London. The original Peabody homes, built before 1900, have stood the test of time, and we put millions of pounds into keeping all of our properties warm and weathertight with modern facilities. We maintain our outside areas to a very high standard and we are making our estates greener, safer and more suited to play.

As well as investing in our existing homes, we are building new ones. We are regenerating our St John's Hill estate in Battersea to replace the existing 351 homes with 527 high quality new ones, and we will deliver at least 1,000 new homes a year by 2015/16.

Our financial strength and capacity means that, by working together with Gallions, we will be in a strong position to drive the regeneration of Thamesmead.

There is plenty of work to do, with challenges ahead, but there is great potential for the area. We are looking forward to working with our partners and local residents to achieve this.

PEABODY'S HISTORY

Peabody is one of London's oldest and largest charitable housing associations, founded in 1862 by the American philanthropist George Peabody. Operating only in London, we have 20,000 properties across 25 London boroughs, providing homes for 50,000 people. Our residents hold a variety of tenures, including social housing, shared ownership, supported housing and keyworker accommodation. Peabody also runs a wide range of community programmes, including employment and training support, youth activities, help for older people to remain independent, and volunteering opportunities.



MEET GALLIONS REFUSE ENFORCEMENT OFFICER: ERNEL COTTRELL

Describe a bit about your job?

I start very early in the morning before Team Gallions goes out and cleans. This makes it easier because I see the rubbish before they pick it up, this way I'm able to get evidence and take it back to the office.

When we get to the enforcement stage there is several warnings before finally a meeting is carried out to find out what the problem is and why the resident continues to dispose rubbish incorrectly. I then inform them – everything from containing rubbish, to disposing, recycling and where they can dispose of larger items.

I think the biggest issue is for people living in tower blocks. A lot of residents use large black waste bags that will not fit down the chute. Many of our residents will end up putting the rubbish bags beside the chute causing smell and health issues.

My role is to speak to people face to face educating them on using smaller bags, taking the rubbish out every time they leave rather than letting it build up. I also work very closely with Greenwhich and Bexley council on best practice and how we can work together to have our residents recycle and use the rubbish bins correctly.

What's the best part?

Seeing the results. Hot spots that were an eye sore and health hazardous are now are looking clean and clear. What I'm trying to do is to get residents to love their area. This also solves other issues like getting rid of vermin.

Basically, I think it's down to awareness. We are going much further than before

to solve the problem. Bexley council is being proactive too: we all want to make the area look and feel better.

What is one thing you would like residents to know about your role?

I'm approachable and willing to work with them to solve their environment problems. I'm always there to listen to their complaints and to help them solve rubbish issues.

Tell me a bit about yourself

I'm an easy going person, I never judge people and will always listen. I have been working with local government for 15 years in estate management. From there I've learnt a lot of how to deal with the public. If you let them explain their problem first, they're more likely to listen to you and it's easier to work with them when they know you will listen to them too.



FREE FINANCIAL ADVICE

Be wary of dodgy door step lenders and pay day loan operators offering to lend you quick money with low weekly repayments. They may appear low to begin with but over time they do add up. You could end up paying those dodgy lenders interest in excess of 1000% per year. But fear not as help is at hand.

Fair Finance offers free and impartial, confidential advice and guidance for anybody who needs help managing their money, be it affordable loans to help with school uniforms or debt consolidation and microcredit loans for new and exciting businesses.

Based at Trust Thamesmead's office in Thamesmead Town Centre, 9:00am-5:00pm every Tuesday, Wednesday and Friday, Fair Finance also offers referral appointments through GPs at Lakeside Health Centre.

If you could benefit from Fair Finance's help, get in touch!

t: 020 7702 8032 or 020 8320 4470
e: info@fairmoneyadvice.co.uk
www.fairfinance.org.uk

HOW ARE WE PERFORMING?

OVERALL RESIDENT SATISFACTION
(data based on information gathered every two years)

RESIDENTS SATISFACTION WITH REPAIRS
(data based on information gathered every two years)

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NEIGHBOURHOOD AS A PLACE TO LIVE (data based on information gathered every two years)

		TARGET	
Void re-let in days		25%	
Emergency repairs completed within 4hrs		98%	
Urgent repairs completed within 24 hrs		97%	
Complaints answered within 10 working days		90%	
Percentage of residents satisfied with the complaints process		75%	
Rent arrears (total figure)			
Calls answered within 20 seconds		80%	
Overall satisfaction with keeping communal areas clean and tidy	Internal	77%	
	External	77%	

APR-DEC			
2010/11	2011/12	2012/13	
77%	77%	80%	☺
79%	79%	78%	😐
58%	58%	74%	☺
31.87%	23.72%	24.2%	😐
99.82%	99.42%	97.19%	😐
99.55%	99.59%	98.92%	☺
91.47%	98.45%	98.16%	☺
84%	83.33%	84.78%	☺
£1,110,300.00	£1,125,195.00	£1,245,250.00	
82.71%	86.32%	95.38%	☺
N/A	71.47%	82.57%	☺
N/A	N/A	81.9%	☺

Community project proves that it builds relationships

Neighbours from Coralline Walk braved the weather for the past month to take part in the 'Colour Coralline' project, which was led by community artist Steve Wilson. Residents chose the painting out of three different options at the beginning of December. It features a bird with various colours surrounding the painting.

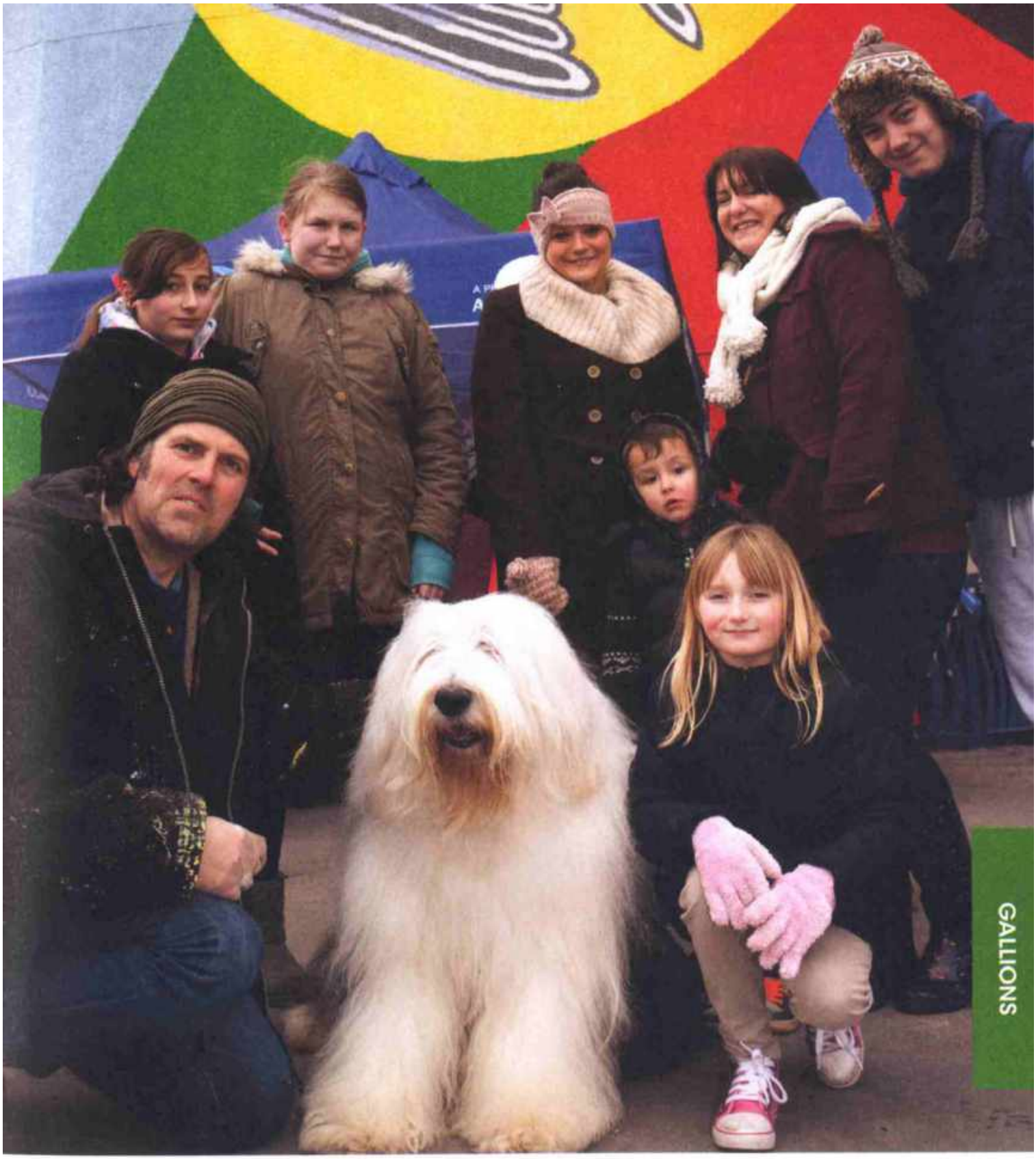
The project is part of a wider community project by Dulux called 'Let's Paint a Difference'. Partners Gallions Housing Association, London Borough of Bexley, Trust Thamesmead and GroundWork London came together to deliver the community project.

Emma Wilson who lives at Coralline Walk said it made her feel proud of where she lives. 'We stand out now, I can say to people I live in the block- you know the one with the bright colours and they will know exactly what I'm talking about.' Not only does the block look like a different building with the colour that stretches all the way down the walkway down to the pavement, but it was a project that supported neighbours meeting each other and starting community cohesion.

Ms. Wilson agreed – 'I've met neighbours that I had seen around, but never had the opportunity to talk to. This project has allowed me to meet people in my community and now we even discussed getting together when the project is finished. I think it has really brought out the best in people.'

During the painting day, adults were helping kids stencil and neighbours who had never had a full conversation were suddenly having a cup of tea and discussing their neighbourhood. There was even a common consensus around the block that they would have a neighbourhood community barbeque when the weather warms up.

Local Councillor John Davey said: 'What the residents created was brilliant. It shows that there is a real community spirit and you can tell Coralline walk residents are proud of where they live and what they were able to accomplish as they should be.' What the project



proves is that these community projects work. Not only do they create a difference physically, but it gives neighbours an excuse to meet each other, communicate and find common ground in an age where it is the norm to know your neighbour or your community.

REGENERATION UPDATE:
WHAT'S NEW AT SOUTHMERE VILLAGE?

BATS AND GALLIONS HOP & SHOP SERVICE

The Hop & Shop service has been in operation for 6 months; we welcome your views so please let us know what you think of the service, feed back forms are available on the bus.

Or alternatively you can contact us directly. The service operates Monday and Thursday between 09:00 – 15:00 and travels to: Abbey Wood, Morrisons, Thamesmead, Woolwich and Local Chemist.

The service is aimed at the elderly, frail and disabled. You can pre-order the service by dialing 01322 – 311333.

Hoarding

You may have already noticed that the temporary hoarding is currently being replaced by permanent hoarding in preparation for the demolition, which is scheduled to commence shortly.

Please be vigilant as the hoarding will extend from the centre of the estate to the edge of the estate, in some areas this will alter the way you navigate around the estate. Please see map below. The map will be available in the Health Centre, Library, and display boards.





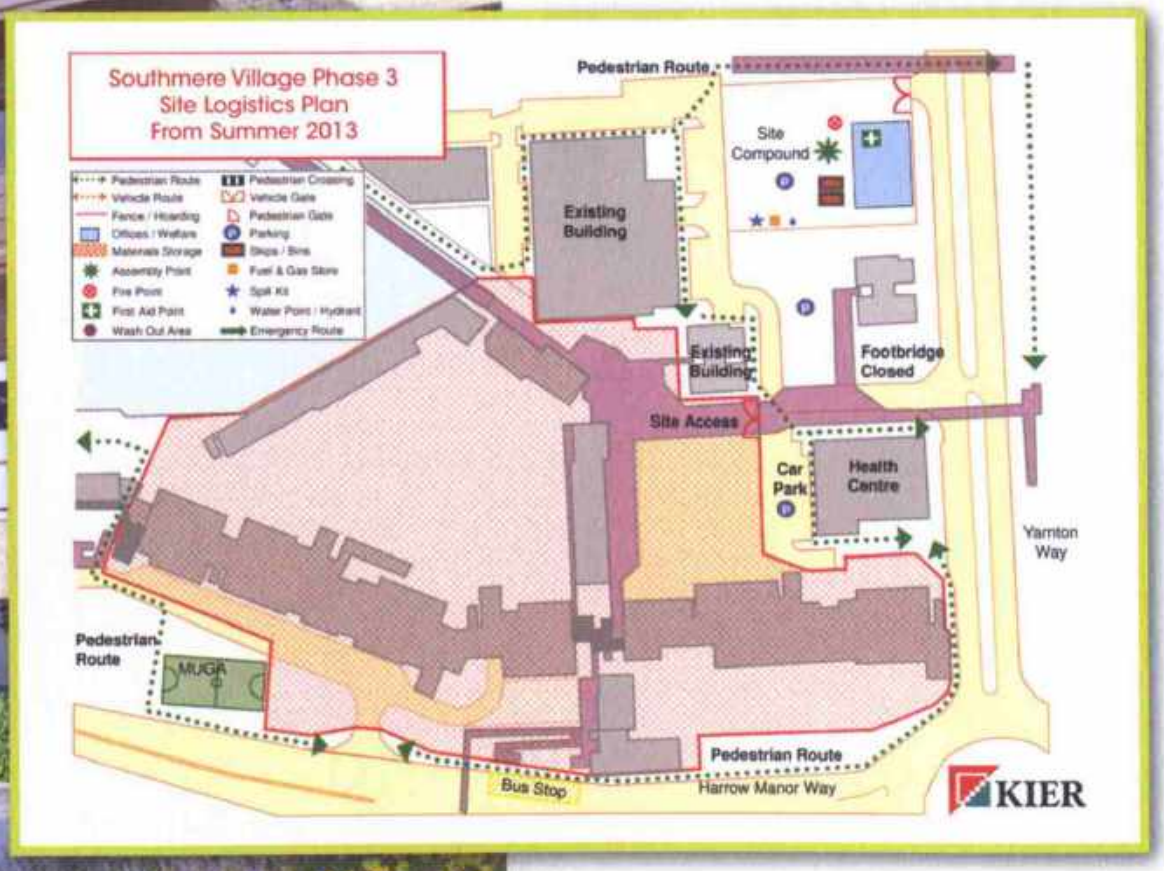
Library

The temporary library is scheduled to re-locate to the Northern end of Binsey Walk in June 2013. The main entrance will be off Belvedere Road near The Link. Once the re-location date has been confirmed, Gallions and Bexley will issue a joint statement informing the general public of the closing date for the existing library and opening times etc for the temporary library.

Drop in sessions at The Link

We are keen to find alternative methods to make ourselves available to residents. If you would like to get in contact, please email or call us.

Email: Southmere.info@gallionsha.co.uk
Tel: 0300 123 1237





ALSIKE ROAD RESIDENTS TAKE PART TO HELP SHAPE THEIR COMMUNITY

RESIDENTS FROM ALSIKE ROAD TOOK PART IN A CONSULTATION PROCESS FOR THE IMPROVEMENT WORKS PROPOSED AROUND DEXTER, ARGALI AND HARLEQUIN HOUSES.

Residents' contribution and feedback for the community gardens have been selected as one of the best set of ideas. It is an important contribution of residents throughout the regeneration process including - raising concerns, voicing your opinions, sharing good ideas and taking ownership of the gardens once they are built.

Local resident, Caroline Pilbro said she hopes residents who live in the area will take part in the gardening once it's finished 'I'm really hoping that it will create community sports and that people in the tower block will get involved'.

As an experience gardener herself, Caroline said she would also be helping people by giving them gardening advice.

CHARLTON ATHLETIC TRUST AND GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION TEAM UP TO DELIVER 'JUNIOR MASTER COOK' AT WINDRUSH PRIMARY

GALLIONS AND CHARLTON RECENTLY HELD A JUNIOR MASTER COOK COMPETITION AT WINDRUSH PRIMARY. THREE STUDENTS WERE CHOSEN TO REPRESENT THEIR CLASS IN A COOKING COMPETITION.

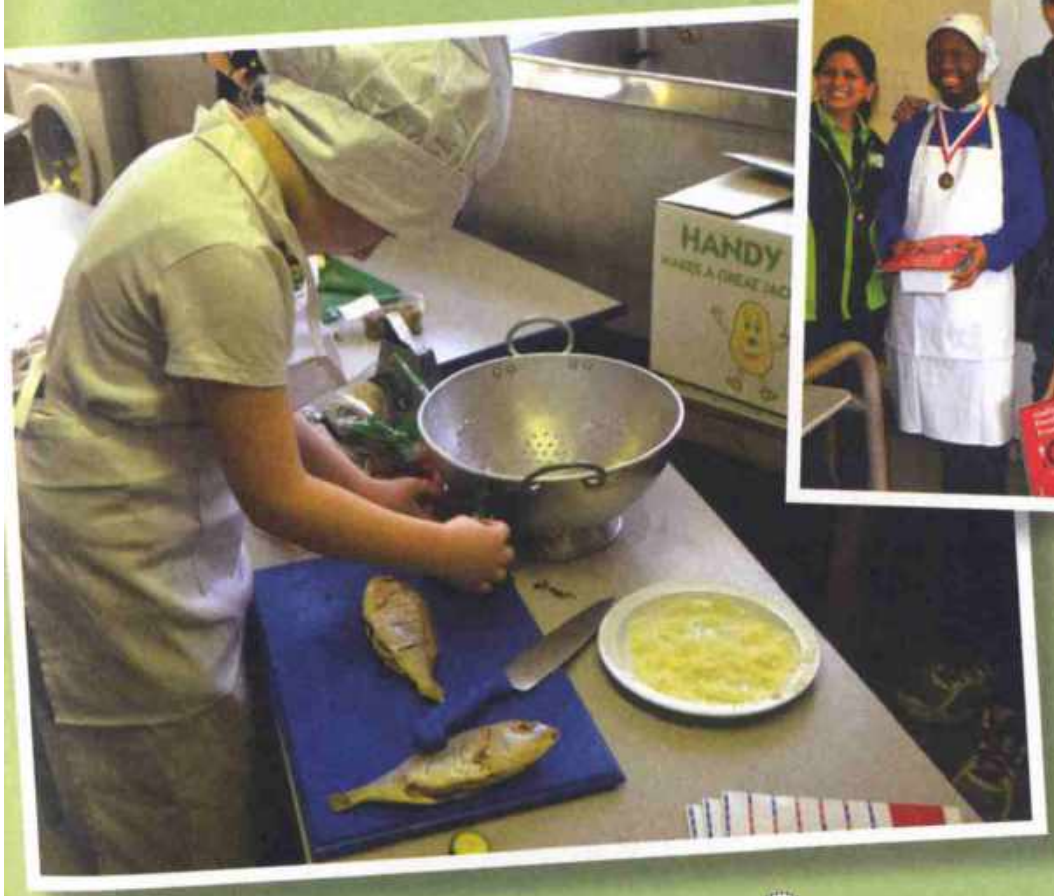
The three students were presented with the prizes by a Charlton Footballer and the winner will go on to compete with other schools. Well done to those students involved!

As part of this project, we have 8 signed cookbooks to give away.

The cookbooks are signed by Scott Wagstaff, midfielder. The first 8 residents to email in will get a signed copy sent to them. Email Kelly Sullivan at ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk to get your signed copy!

If you miss out on signed copies, not to worry there are additional copies of the cookbook at Joyce Dawson Way office to pick up. Our address: 15 Joyce Dawson Way, London, SE28 8RA.





DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

V&A MUSEUM OF CHILDHOOD

Cambridge Heath Road, London E2
(Bethnal Green Tube)

An impressive collection of toys and other interesting objects going back as far as 1300 BC.

Open daily from 10:00am - 5:45pm.
www.vam.ac.uk/moc
t: 020 8983 5200/020 8983 5235

NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY

Trafalgar Square, London
Every Sunday • Free

Family activities for all the family.
www.nationalgallery.org.uk t: 020 7747 2885

TELL US ABOUT YOUR UP AND COMING COMMUNITY EVENTS

Do you have any community events that you would like us to consider promoting in the July issue of Thamesview?

Then why not email us details; include what the event is all about, when it will be taking place and the location. Also include your contact details so that residents could get in touch if they need to find out more.

Email the information to
communications@gallionsha.co.uk

WIN WITH OUR WORD SEARCH

IN THIS WORDSEARCH WE HAVE HIDDEN THE NAMES OF SIX DIFFERENT SOAPS. FIND THEM ALL AND YOU COULD WIN A £30 SHOPPING VOUCHER.

Eastenders
Waterloo Road
Hollyoaks
Neighbours
Emmerdale
The Bill

W	Q	E	W	F	E	G	R	H	T	I	Y	E
U	A	I	G	O	M	F	N	U	O	L	P	M
Q	G	T	H	O	L	L	Y	O	A	K	S	M
X	Y	L	E	V	A	M	B	N	C	M	D	E
M	E	A	F	R	G	I	H	E	I	T	J	R
T	H	E	B	I	L	L	S	O	R	P	F	D
G	R	T	M	J	T	O	U	L	V	Z	W	A
X	C	E	W	Z	E	A	O	B	M	C	Q	L
D	E	R	F	Y	G	D	R	R	G	O	N	E
I	K	N	N	E	I	G	H	B	O	U	R	S
Q	H	R	K	R	E	D	I	U	Y	A	K	X
C	Y	V	Z	B	A	N	B	M	C	Q	D	W
E	A	S	T	E	N	D	E	R	S	X	A	P

DID YOU KNOW...

Eastenders it is one of the UK's highest-rated programmes, often appearing near or at the top of the week's BARB ratings. Within eight months of its launch, it reached the number-one spot in the ratings, and has consistently remained among the top-rated TV programmes in Britain.

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Communications Team, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 14 June 2013. The winner will be selected at random.

Name:

Address:

Telephone:

Email:

CONGRATULATIONS... to Rebecca Gouge who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Kidsview WORDSEARCH

IN THIS WORDSEARCH WE HAVE HIDDEN THE NAMES OF SIX ANIMALS. IF YOU ARE LUCKY ENOUGH TO FIND ALL SIX YOU COULD WIN A DVD PACK.

TIGER
DOG
FISH
COW
SHARK
CAT

T	I	G	E	R	W	R	X	T	V	P	J	U
J	T	L	G	E	K	T	Q	M	P	O	I	W
A	N	P	M	B	L	A	K	X	J	T	H	L
I	K	G	I	F	F	E	U	C	A	A	Z	B
T	U	R	C	O	W	Z	D	S	E	T	F	C
G	L	H	K	I	O	J	C	K	J	O	U	A
D	F	E	O	G	P	D	O	G	R	C	S	T
T	I	U	S	V	R	X	R	Y	Q	Z	M	A
N	S	R	C	K	D	I	R	H	F	U	G	L
H	H	I	P	J	A	K	O	L	F	M	Z	N
H	P	O	T	S	O	P	T	Q	L	R	X	S
U	T	A	U	D	V	G	X	J	Y	L	Z	W
A	C	T	C	U	Z	S	H	A	R	K	R	G

This competition is just for kids under 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Communications Team, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 14 June 2013.
The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name:

Parent's name:

Address:

Telephone:

WELL DONE ...
to Queen Fashina who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition.